

Epson Stylus C79

Terrible in our text test

Epson's C79 is positioned as an affordable home printer capable of little more than the usual home printing tasks. Although it's well built and the body feels sturdy, the C79 looks a little angular. But that's not necessarily a bad thing. It's reasonably light on desktop space. Efforts to further reduce its footprint are evident from the detachable input and output trays. With a two colour (light-grey / dark-grey) combination and a translucent fibre top, Epson has gotten their colour combinations right.

A few minutes into our tests, it became clear that the C79 is a slowcoach. Taking close to four and a half minutes to print an A4 photo isn't exactly express. Similarly, the combination document took a painful amount of time. The adage goes, "A little late, but worth the wait!"—not so with the text printing capabilities on the C79. Unlike its

sibling the R390, which redeemed itself somewhat when the settings were bumped up, the C79 brought out sub-standard results throughout the monochrome tests, totally



inexplicably, even after we repeated the tests several times. We do hope this is a one-off glitch with the piece we received, and not a fault in general with the model.

Performance in the combination document test was more like what we expected. The C79 did well in the point readability test (text), and performed very

well (in fact, the best in its class) with the embedded photo. However, reverse text production suffered somewhat.

It's not that it's very bad—just that the Canons ran away with all the accolades here thanks to better contrast in the output.

The C79 isn't very capable at professional photo printing. It performed decently overall, but a closer perusal of the test photograph showed that the portraits weren't as detailed as we'd hoped, with highlighting on the skin missing. The C79 also had noticeable issues with the exact skin tone, which it got wrong. Specular highlights were as good as with the other printers.

Overall, at Rs 4,299, the C79 seems to excel at pretty much nothing. We weren't expecting world-class photo printing at this price point, but it's the failure to impress in the text print-out test that worries us—because text is what its intended target audience will be printing most of the time.



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Technical Specifications		Main Features	
Model	PT-M218	The PowerLite PT-M218 Projector (1017011)	
Resolution	1024x768 (DVI-D)	1024x768 Display Function	
Contrast	800:1	Smart Projection Function in PowerLite Presentation Mode	
Light source	300W UHP lamp (30000 hours)	100% ENERGY STAR COMPLIANT	
Light output	1000 ANSI LUMENS	Best Price To Keep The LCD Panel (Class E Super All-in-One)	
Screen Size	2-11.5m (wide frequency double mode)	The Most Continuous To Watch After The Projector Is Turned Off (Waiting for 10 minutes auto standby time 10)	
Power	115W (115W AT 100% ON)	Warranty 3 years for Projector and 5 years for lamp (unlimited hours of use)	
Projection distance	1.2m-3.8m		
Projection dimension	20" x 14"		
Input			
Weight	2.5kg		
Body size	300x200x100mm		

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